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Q3. (a) Write a note on the biological and socio-ecological factors affecting fecundity and Fertility 15

Fecundity may be defined as the ability of
a woman to bear children. Biological capacity to reproduce

Fertility is the actual reproductive performance
of a woman. to bear a live child

Biological Factors

Genetic disorders

Adolescent sterility
postpartum sterility

- 1) Age at menarche & menopause.
 - The time period between menarche & menopause is the actual fecundity.
 - A study by Prof Majumdar among Ho revealed that there was late menarche among girls due to malnutrition.
- 2) Use of contraceptives like wadome, i-pills etc.
- 3) Amount of sexual intercourse.

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Socio-ecological factors

- 1) Economic conditions like poverty affects the growth of reproductive organs, & thus affects fertility & fecundity.
- 2) Illiteracy & superstitions in societies where use of contraception is considered as taboo.
- 3) Age of marriage of girls is also important. In Modern societies, girls usually marry at an older age.
- 4) Nutrition also affects the fertility & fecundity. High prevalence of malnutrition like stunting & wasting delays menarche.
- 5) Various family planning programs like One Child Policy of China.

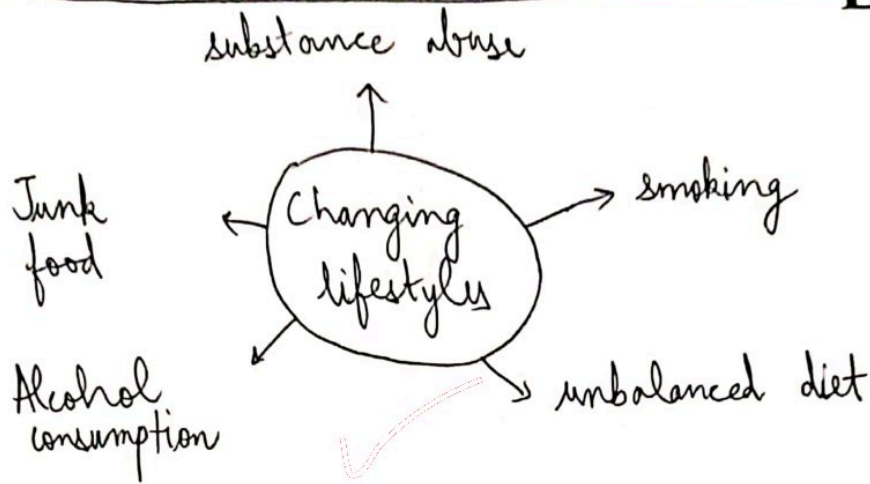
Also mention environmental factors

High altitude - High blood pressure during pregnancy resulting in miscarriage

Present relevance

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Various lifestyle changes also affects the fertility & fecundity along with various biological & socio-ecological factors.

